

ET Award

2009-10

FOR CORPORATE EXCELLENCE

BUSINESSWOMAN OF THE YEAR

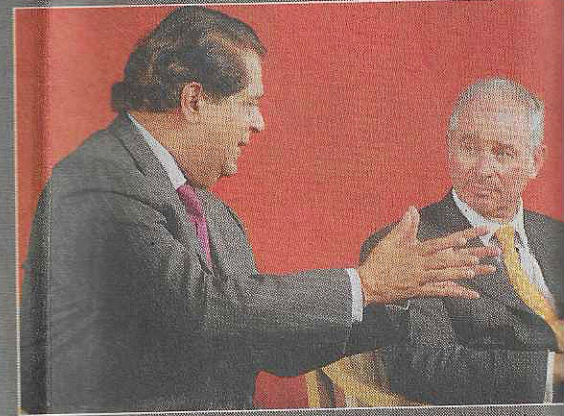
BOBBY



WARD SEEKS TO
a professional who
played exceptional
ship qualities and is
model for others

RE THAN FATHER'S GHTER

Y, WHO HAS BEEN CHOSEN THE
ic Times Businesswoman of the Year
d she will be happy if the recognition
s "an inspiration to someone and
t there is less of a glass ceiling and that
ur dreams".
foremost corporate lawyers and a co-
- Partners, she is among the very few
eration to have broken the glass ceil-
y still consider to be a male-dominated
as an enviable roster of clients and hers
names that come to mind when the
dia Inc want to go shopping for big ac-
ber in the country or overseas.
e seemed like the most obvious calling
face her father is among the most



THE THINK TANK: (Clockwise from bottom) Vimal Bhandari, Ravi Narain and Ajay Srinivasan; Bobby Parekh; Harish Manwani with Digvijaya Singh; KV Kamath makes a point to Schwab

MELINDA GATES

Man Who Devised MBA Oath Thinks Global

GLOBAL INDIAN

NITIN NOHRIA

NITIN NOHRIA, THE FIRST FOREIGN-BORN dean of the Harvard Business School (HBS) and a man who believes management is not a true profession, is The Economic Times Global Indian of the Year 2010.

Prof Nohria, who succeeded Jay Light as the dean of HBS in July, brings fresh perspective to thinking on leadership, arguing that business leaders should go beyond responsibility to the shareholder to include a civic and personal commitment.

Last year, more than half of Harvard's graduating batch took Prof Nohria's MBA oath, as did students of 200 other business schools across the world. Global corporates have also embraced the concept of a code for managers on the lines of the Hippocratic Oath for doctors, introducing it as a part of the induction programme for fresh graduates.

A chemical engineer from IIT-Bombay, which honoured him as a distinguished alumnus, Prof Nohria did his PhD from Sloan School of Management at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology before joining HBS in 1988. In his 22 years at Harvard (with a one-year stint at the London Business School, where he was visiting faculty in 1996), he has done much to extend the frontiers of knowledge in his field, co-authoring numerous research papers and 16 books.

Kewal Nohria, a former chairman of Crompton Greaves and the father of Prof Nohria, was delighted to hear about the latest honour for his son. "This is wonderful news. I'm really very proud of Nitin," he said. Prof Nohria could not be contacted.

His appointment as dean of the world's most famous business school is a watershed achieve-

ment, but it is also the grand culmination of a trend that started two decades ago when the late CK Prahlad, in collaboration with Gary Hamel, published 'The Core Competence of an Organisation' in the Harvard Business Review, an influential article that catapulted Prof Prahlad into the ranks of the world's top management thinkers. It was also the beginning of the ascendancy of a new league of management gurus of Indian origin on the global academic firmament.

The greatest concentration of management thinkers of Indian origin was at the HBS. In their initial years, Harvard professors like Nitin Nohria, Krishna Palepu, Pankaj Ghemawat and Tarun Khanna engaged in a broad spectrum of research. Then, at the turn of the century, they led a new trend — research into emerging markets. India became the new frontier of management research, with Harvard leading the way.

Prof Nohria has been at the forefront of Harvard's global push. At a time when India was still not fashionable with the Western academic establishment, he was a part of the faculty team on several management development programmes conducted by Harvard in league with organisations like the All India Management Association.

Upon assuming charge as the dean of HBS, his first initiative was to embark on a world tour covering the five cities where Harvard has research centres. He told ET on the Mumbai leg of his tour that one of his priorities is to make Harvard even more global than it currently is.

He plans to do this by expanding and strengthening Harvard's research centres abroad, in places like Mumbai, London, Hong Kong, Shanghai.



THE AWARD SEEKS TO honour Indians who have set standards in excellence on a global platform and have emerged as role models for people of Indian origin world over

BHARTI FOUNDATION

With The A, B, C Of Philanthropy

30k Children Can Aim To Break Free

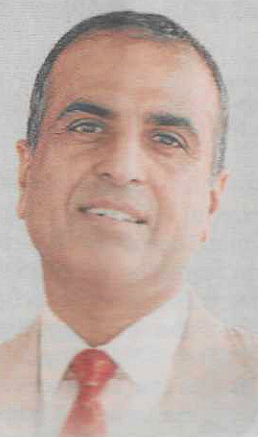
about 236 Satya Bharti Primary schools impart free English-medium education operational in Punjab, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu. Schools are being run at an annual cost of Rs 10 crore.

Education and ambition in telecoms is also driving an old philanthropic project. The number of students in these schools is 10,000. "If you can teach a child, his family and future is taken care of. It has a multiplier effect," he said. The foundation started setting up schools in 2000. The Mittal brothers felt that writing grants or partnering with them to fulfil their ambitions of putting education in school. They hired a team of

dedicated professionals, led by a CEO, and committed a corpus of Rs200 crore for the Bharti Foundation to get this venture rolling.

Mittal occasionally visits some of these schools when he travels to Punjab and Rajasthan, while his elder brother Rakesh, who is the co-chairman of the Bharti Foundation and the head of the group's CSR activities, goes there often. The Mittal brothers have given full freedom and autonomy to Chadda, who runs the day-to-day operations. In the long run, the Bharti Foundation plans to scale up the Satya Bharti School Program to 500 primary schools and 50 senior secondary schools. The foundation has a team of 1,700 employees. Three state-heads oversee the functioning of about 90 schools each, and report to the headquarters in Delhi.

THE AWARD SEEKS TO honour the contribution to public good through commitment to critical social causes that influence the lives of thousands of needy Indians



BILL AND MELINDA GATES FOUNDATION
BILL GATES

Harish Manwani & Co. listen to Stephen...



Madhabi Puri-Bhargava



Akhil Gupta



Habib Khorrammanesh